

1. Could you please confirm that industrial leading best practices/good programming secure coding standards (i.e. OWASP ASVS, OWASP Top 10 etc.) are adhered during the application development process?

*Yes, we adhere to the leading industry practices and secure coding standards during our application development process. Our data security team rigorously conducts standard OWASP scans with each software version release, proactively addressing critical vulnerabilities. We also manage other vulnerabilities based on security assessments, with a detailed strategy for each—immediate repair, scheduling for the next release, or justified non-action for no-impact findings. All actions are meticulously documented for integrity and traceability.*

2. Did you implement any Virus Protection software with Chemical.ai?

*Indeed, advanced virus protection is implemented within our platform. We employ advanced hardware firewalls and our data security team conduct continuous surveillance for any signs of unusual activities.*

3. During the evaluation, the developers' access to proprietary data should be blocked/prohibited. Is the trial conducted in your production environment or development environment?

*For trial phases, we assure you that the environment is strictly production-based. Our development team has no access to proprietary data during this phase. To protect your valuable data, we implement robust security measures like access controls, AES256 encryption, and data anonymization, which are closely monitored to prevent any unauthorized access.*

4. Does Chemical.ai work offline or does it require an internet connection? Is there any chance that the data accessed by Chemical.ai could be accessible from the internet at any point?

*Chemical.ai can work both offline (local deployment to Merck's internal server) and online (SaaS, cloud-based).*

- *For the cloud-based model, Chemical.ai requires an internet connection for data submission, and data handling is confined within Chemical.ai and doesn't interact with third-party services. In our production environment, only essential modules can interface with the internet, and these are limited to receiving and returning user requests.*
- *For high-profile clients, such as top pharmaceutical companies like Merck, we can alternatively provide a local software deployment, eliminating any internet-associated data security concerns, facilitating secure integration with internal systems for data reuse and algorithm retraining.*

5. In the evolution process, there is involvement of proprietary data, and it is challenging to mask the chemistry structure. Could you kindly provide information about the data flow subsequent to the data submission? Will it be stored in a backdoor database (or any other storage media)?

*Upon submission of chemical molecular information, the data flows securely; using HTTPS for transmission to our backend services, where it's immediately encrypted with RSA256 before being stored. We ensure that your data is not replicated, reused, or distributed, ensuring confidentiality from the point of entry to its secure, encrypted storage.*

6. How does the company ensure that secure data deletion mechanisms, such as data sanitization and/or physical destruction, are implemented upon testing? Are measures in place to guarantee that sensitive data is securely decommissioned and cannot be retrieved by unauthorized individuals from discarded storage hardware?

*We employ rigorous data sanitization methods to ensure complete and secure data deletion post-testing. All data are encrypted and stored on technologically advanced storage mediums with RAID 5 and LVM, accompanied by encrypted off-site backups, to negate any possibility of data retrieval by unauthorized parties from any discarded hardware.*

7. It has been specified that account sharing is prohibited, with the requirement that it should be limited to individual users. Given the considerable number of chemists interested in the evaluation, what is the maximum number of accounts that can be generated for the trial?

*We understand the importance of individual user experiences during the trial and are prepared to accommodate as many users as necessary. While ensuring that the number of accounts remains within reasonable bounds, we strictly enforce single-device login policies to maintain data integrity and security, automatically logging out previous sessions upon new logins to prevent account sharing.*